CTL DECISION SHEET (DSH)

Standard(s) (incl. year)	Subclause(s)	Tracking No.	Year
IEC 60601-1:2005 + Am1 IEC 60601-1-8:2006	7.8.1 Colours of indicator lights	2021	2015
Category			
MED			
Subject	**Keywords**	**Developed by**	**Approved at**
Blinking indicator lights	Indicator lights, colours	ETF-3	2016 CTL Plenary Meeting

Question

IEC 60601-1:2005 states the following:

7.8.1 Colours of indicator lights
The colours of indicator lights and their meanings shall comply with Table 2.
NOTE IEC 60601-1-8 contains specific requirement for the colour, flashing frequency and DUTY CYCLE of alarm indicator lights.
Dot-matrix and other alphanumeric displays are not considered to be indicator lights.

Table 2 – Colours of indicator lights and their meaning for ME EQUIPMENT

Colour	Meaning
Red	Warning – immediate response by the OPERATOR is required
Yellow	Caution – prompt response by the OPERATOR is required
Green	Ready for use
Any other colour	Meaning other than that of red, yellow or green

Standard IEC 60601-1-8 (Alarm signals) covers only red and yellow lights. In case of alarm, blinking increases the priority of the alarm. In the 2nd edition the meaning of colours was practically identical.

Is it possible to use a blinking green light to attract attention with no prompt response required?

Decision

Yes. The use of a green indicator light (blinking or not) may mean “ready for use”.

Explanatory notes

Blinking of any other than red, green or yellow light has no special purpose of requirement in the standard.